

Nokia N95

Convergence Has A New Name

All it takes is a look to conclude this is a flagship product, a high-end multimedia cell phone, with a hell of a lot of features crammed into one tiny shell. And what a shell that is—the colour combinations are classy (we received a silver-dull metallic green), as is the matte finish. Quality of plastic is top-notch.

We were surprised at the compactness of the thing, especially when you consider the functionality: the 5MP camera, and the absolutely gorgeous 2.6-inch, 24-bit screen (nearly all phones still use 18-bit screens).

The number keypad is well laid out—an achievement for a slider phone—but the hard touch keys combined with the slightly raised surface makes finger-pad touch-typing a pain. Thankfully the keys are suitably laid out for nail-touch typing.

The double slider is a first—slide down and your number pad is accessible, slide up and four (blue backlit) media player keys pop into view. Another first—a 3.5 mm jack inbuilt on a Nokia phone! While grooving to MP3s, all calls are automatically diverted to the loudspeaker.

The music player's very functional. Sound quality is decent on the supplied earplugs, but the N95 really comes into its own on a set of good plugs—this phone is an MP3 killer!

The 5MP camera is another first—great image quality and a good flash unit. However, like with all phone cameras, the zoom is useless. A boon is the lens protector.

2 GB of MicroSD comes bundled; its hot-swap. There's a fully-functional GPS application inbuilt. This works well in conjunction with a GPRS connection. Wi-



Fi (g protocol) is inbuilt, as is the mandatory Bluetooth (version 2.0, now with A2DP), and the Jurassic IR. The N95 also incorporates FM radio.

One gripe is the battery—950 mAh just isn't going to



be enough for such a feature-rich phone.

An excellent piece of hardware—loads of features, stunning looks, and an amazing screen—in short performance to match the looks. It's pricey at Rs 40,249 we'd suggest waiting for a price cut, but keep in mind, at this price point, there's nothing close to matching the N95!

Specifications

Tri-band GSM; Symbian OS Series 60 version 3.1; weight: 120 gm; screen: 240 x 320 (2.6 inches); 160 MB internal memory; EDGE/3G support; 5MP camera; inbuilt GPS

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Web site: www.nokia.co.in

Price: Rs 40,249

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Antec 900

Cool!

Antec's not been in the enthusiast league for a while, and their homage to that fraternity has been long due. Enter the Antec 900.

A Plexiglas side window ensures that monster gets all the looks in and the drool out! There's a very rugged, industrial look to the front, with an aggressively forward-sloping top. Although the body is made of cold rolled sheet steel, the Antec 900 feels very light, especially for its size.

The 120mm fan that served the P180 topside has been ditched in favour of a colossal 200mm fan that serves as an exhaust. There are two blue LED-lit 120mm fans in the front, and draw in a lot of air (courtesy the perforated

front). Antec adds another 120mm fan to the rear of the cabinet to aid removal of hot air; excellent thermal management all round. All fans have been provided with a 3-speed controller switch.

The PSU is floor-mounted, reminiscent of the P180, but not thermally isolated. This is good since cable management in the P180 was a royal pain.

To generate heat we ran a few 3D 2006 Marks, and played F.E.A.R. for around half an hour, on a Core 2 Duo X6800 and 8800GTX



based rig. Then we monitored temperatures.

Pretty impressive, isn't it... though not without the odd fault, it does cater to its default audience rather well. You get decent build quality for the most part, very good cooling, plenty of expansion, and a body that will attract

glances at any LAN party. What you don't get is drive rails, a large bay to work in, and the sound of silence. At Rs 8,400 plus tax, cheap it's not. But then you wouldn't want to house a Porsche in a barn, now, would you?

Specifications

Dimensions: 493 x 206 x 468 mm (L x W x H); weight: 8.4 kg; 4x fans (3 x 120 mm, 1 x 200 mm)

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

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